DOCUMENT 05 / SMART UNIVERSITY DIGITAL CAMPUS

Impact & Benefits

An evidence-minded assessment of the value UniSphere could create for students, parents, staff, and university leadership.

Assessment basis Project workflows and code reviewed on 1 October 2026. Benefits below are expected outcomes. No production impact study or verified savings figure is available.

Why this matters

UniSphere connects student identity, academic records, campus services, certificates, helpdesk, parent visibility, and AI assistance in one account-based experience. Its value depends on the university maintaining authoritative records and staff completing the service workflows. The platform can reduce office visits and information gaps when those conditions hold.

Expected impact by stakeholder

Area	Expected benefit	Mechanism and limit
Student experience	Fewer repeated enquiries; clearer service status.	Student portal displays account-specific records and submitted requests. Some actions still require staff approval.
Education	Earlier support for attendance or performance concerns.	Risk warnings help staff review cases. The current score is a heuristic, not a validated prediction.
Governance	More visible ownership and record trails.	Admin workflows assign and update academic and service data. A full audit interface remains future work.
Social inclusion	More flexible access for students and families.	English/Hindi assistance and parent linkage help access. Assisted service channels remain necessary.
Economic capacity	Less routine re-entry and follow-up time.	Staff may redirect time to higher-value cases; time saved is not automatically a cash saving.

Current scope The working prototype supports student, parent, and admin portals, backend-held Gemini access, service certificates, hostel and transport allocations, and recorded fee operations. Live payment gateway settlement and campus-wide deployment are not evidenced.

Illustrative efficiency scenario

The following is a planning calculation for one semester, not an observed result. It makes assumptions transparent so evaluators can replace them with local data.

Assumption	Illustrative input	Calculation
Cohort	500 participating students	Pilot planning size; no capacity claim.
Routine requests	2 per student per semester	500 × 2 = 1,000 requests.
Student time	15 minutes avoided per request	1,000 × 15 / 60 = 250 hours.
Staff time	5 minutes avoided per request	1,000 × 5 / 60 = 83.3 hours.
At 50% adoption	500 requests shifted	125 student hours; 41.7 staff hours.

Formula: time returned = eligible requests × digital adoption × minutes avoided / 60. A credible study must compare actual task times, include failed attempts and support calls, and report the adoption denominator. No salary-rate or travel-cost conversion is claimed here.

How impact will be measured

Measure	Proposed pilot target	Evidence owner
Digital completion	≥80% of eligible initiated requests completed	Service owner; weekly funnel
Request turnaround	Median ≥30% faster than local baseline	Service desk; timestamp sample
Record agreement	≥99% on sampled student-service records	Registrar/data steward; weekly audit
Warning review	≥90% of flagged cases reviewed in 2 working days	Academic support; queue log
Certificate verification	100% accurate on approved sample	Issuer; issue/revoke/verify tests
Critical privacy incidents	Zero during controlled pilot	Institutional security lead

Evaluation design

Capture a two-week baseline for the same service types, then monitor a four-week controlled pilot. Count eligible students, active users, completed requests, failed requests, staff handling time, and unresolved cases. Compare like-for-like tasks; show counts alongside percentages. Report variation by access channel and language rather than hiding low-adoption groups inside an average.

Question	Method	Decision use
Do students finish tasks?	Sample task observation and portal event counts.	Improve forms and navigation.
Does staff time fall?	Timed before/after handling samples, including corrections.	Rework workflow or data ownership.
Is information trustworthy?	Sample academic, invoice, allocation, and certificate records against source systems.	Block expansion until errors are repaired.
Does AI help safely?	Rate sampled answers for accuracy, source grounding, language, escalation, and harmful advice.	Restrict or revise answer categories.

Equity and responsible use

- Provide an assisted office route for students without a suitable device or network access.
- Measure English and Hindi answer quality separately; do not treat language selection as proof of accessibility.
- Use early-warning signals for human support and document the intervention. Do not use them for automatic punitive decisions.
- Collect only the operational data needed for evaluation, with institutional approval, access controls, and retention rules.

Interpretation

A four-week pilot can show whether tasks work and whether process time appears lower. It cannot establish a campus-wide causal impact or long-term dropout reduction. Expansion should require better baseline coverage, larger cohorts, and evidence that data quality and service ownership hold across departments.

Evidence and sources

Project evidence: **EXECUTIVE_SUMMARY.md**; admin and student portal code; backend certificate, AI, risk, hostel, transport, and parent APIs. Benefits, targets, and scenario assumptions are proposed in this document.